

SESSION 3

Templates & Static Files

Topics Covered: Templates folder structure, Template inheritance (base.html), Loading static files (CSS, JS), Using template tags

Activities: Build base.html layout, Add Bootstrap via CDN

Task 1: Create a templates folder in your Django project, and add base.html that includes a simple navigation bar with links for 'Home', 'Explore', and 'Profile'.

Explanation & Approach: *Template layout files serve as master templates from which child pages inherit layout structure.*

```
<!-- templates/base.html -->
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <title>{% block title %}My Web App{% endblock %}</title>
</head>
<body>
  <nav>
    <a href="#">Home</a> |
    <a href="#">Explore</a> |
    <a href="#">Profile</a>
  </nav>
  <hr>
  <div class="content">
    {% block content %}
    {% endblock %}
  </div>
</body>
</html>
```

Task 2: Use Bootstrap via CDN in your base.html to style the navigation bar and add a footer section that remains at the bottom of the page.

Explanation & Approach: *Bootstrap CDN links allow rapid styling without manually downloading CSS framework files.*

```
<!-- templates/base.html (Styled with Bootstrap 5 CDN) -->
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>{% block title %}Spotify & Zomato Hybrid App{% endblock %}</title>
  <!-- Bootstrap CSS CDN -->
  <link href="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/bootstrap@5.3.2/dist/css/bootstrap.min.css"
    rel="stylesheet">
</head>
```

```

<body class="d-flex flex-column min-vh-100">
  <!-- Navbar -->
  <nav class="navbar navbar-expand-lg navbar-dark bg-dark mb-4">
    <div class="container">
      <a class="navbar-link navbar-brand fw-bold text-success" href="#">StreamHub</a>
      <div class="navbar-nav">
        <a class="nav-link active" href="#">Home</a>
        <a class="nav-link" href="#">Explore</a>
        <a class="nav-link" href="#">Profile</a>
      </div>
    </div>
  </nav>

  <!-- Main Content Container -->
  <main class="container flex-grow-1">
    {% block content %}{% endblock %}
  </main>

  <!-- Footer -->
  <footer class="bg-dark text-white text-center py-3 mt-auto">
    <p class="mb-0">&copy; 2026 StreamHub Inc. All rights reserved.</p>
  </footer>

  <script
src="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/bootstrap@5.3.2/dist/js/bootstrap.bundle.min.js"></script
>
</body>
</html>

```

Task 3: Inside templates folder, create home.html that extends base.html and adds a welcome message in main content area.

Explanation & Approach: *Template inheritance using {% extends 'base.html' %} overrides named {% block %} sections while keeping common headers and footers intact.*

```

<!-- templates/home.html -->
{% extends 'base.html' %}

{% block title %}Home - StreamHub{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
<div class="jumbotron p-5 mb-4 bg-light rounded-3 border">
  <h1 class="display-4 font-weight-bold">Welcome to StreamHub!</h1>
  <p class="lead">Discover top trending music playlists and top-rated restaurants all in
one place.</p>
  <a class="btn btn-success btn-lg" href="/explore/" role="button">Start Exploring</a>
</div>
{% endblock %}

```

Task 4: Add a static folder to your project and place style.css inside it. Link static CSS in base.html using {% load static %} and change body background color.

Explanation & Approach: *Django manages static assets (CSS, JS, images) by requiring static file loader tags in templates.*

```
/* static/style.css */
body {
    background-color: #f8f9fa;
    font-family: 'Segoe UI', Tahoma, Geneva, Verdana, sans-serif;
}

.card-title {
    color: #198754;
}
```

Task 5: Create explore.html that extends base.html and displays a grid of 6 Bootstrap cards with dummy images and titles for trending playlists or restaurants.

Explanation & Approach: *Bootstrap grid system (row row-cols-md-3 g-4) cleanly formats dynamic content cards into responsive grid layouts.*

```
<!-- templates/explore.html -->
{% extends 'base.html' %}
{% load static %}

{% block title %}Explore Trending Playlists{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
<h2 class="mb-4 font-weight-bold">Trending Playlists & Top Spotlights</h2>
<div class="row row-cols-1 row-cols-md-3 g-4">
    {% for i in "123456" %}
        <div class="col">
            <div class="card h-100 shadow-sm border-0">
                
                <div class="card-body">
                    <h5 class="card-title font-weight-bold">Top Hits Volume {{ i }}</h5>
                    <p class="card-text">Explore the most played tracks and trending tracks of the week on StreamHub.</p>
                </div>
                <div class="card-footer bg-transparent border-0">
                    <button class="btn btn-outline-success w-100">Listen Now</button>
                </div>
            </div>
        </div>
    {% endfor %}
</div>
{% endblock %}
```